CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

HANDYMAN (SOLO PRO) IN THE AI ERA

Every home has a list of forty small jobs nobody else will show up for — this is the person who does all of them.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K median as a solo pro you can start in 1–6 months, no license required for the small stuff. The catch: you are the business — marketing, pricing, fixing and chasing payment are all you.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

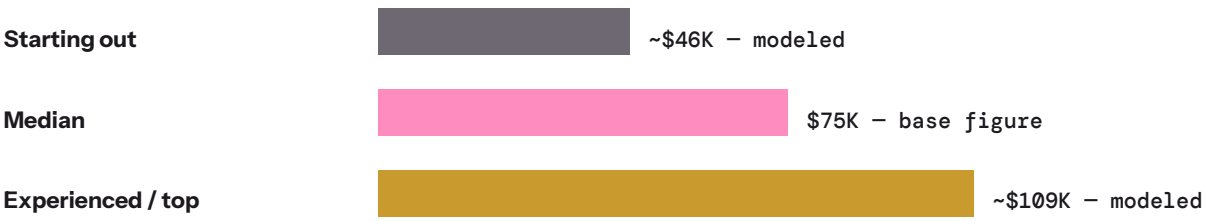
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: homeowners and landlords drown in small repairs too tiny for contractors and too real for DIY.
- Where it bites: income swings with your pipeline — no calls, no money.
- The AI angle: AI can answer inquiries and schedule visits; it cannot patch the drywall, hang the door and fix the leak in one trip.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Handyman (solo pro) is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A HANDYMAN (SOLO PRO) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Work through punch lists: drywall patches, doors, trim, fixtures, minor plumbing and paint
- ✓ Walk homes, spot problems owners missed, and quote on the spot
- ✓ Juggle several small jobs a day across different houses
- ✓ Handle your own bookings, invoices, reviews and referrals

Think: a family doctor for houses — broad skills, honest triage, and knowing when to refer to a specialist.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Booking platforms, AI receptionists and instant-quote tools are eating the admin layer. Listing sites increasingly own the first contact with the customer.	The work itself is a hundred different physical micro-skills in real, crooked, old houses. Versatility plus trust — a stranger in your home — is the moat.

⚠ **Know the legal line cold: plenty of work (electrical panels, gas, structural) belongs to licensed trades, and crossing it risks fines and liability.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Every day is different — no two lists alike ✓ You set your prices, hours and service area ✓ Grateful customers and fast word of mouth	✗ Feast or famine until the referral engine spins up ✗ Evenings spent quoting and invoicing ✗ Your van, your tools, your insurance, your problem

Good fit? You are a competent all-rounder who likes people, variety and being your own boss more than being comfortable.
Bad fit? You want one specialty, a guaranteed paycheck, or work where someone else finds the customers.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — SOLO FROM DAY ONE	DOOR B — HANDYMAN COMPANY OR FRANCHISE CREW

Register the business, get insured, set a minimum job price and start with neighbors and local groups. Small jobs done well turn into reviews, and reviews turn into a route. The fastest door — if your skills are genuinely broad.	Work for an established handyman company first: steady tickets, a wrapped van and a look at real pricing. You trade independence for a paid education in the business side.

Smart move: Package a recurring punch-list visit for landlords and busy homeowners — one standing appointment that knocks out the whole list. Recurring tickets smooth the feast-or-famine cycle.

Where you land after: A booked-out solo practice, or a small crew of handymen with you running estimates and quality.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
AUDIT YOUR	SET UP	PRICE THE	FIRST TEN	BUILD THE	RAISE AND

STEP 1 — Audit your skills honestly

FREE · WEEK 1

- List what you can finish to a pro standard today
- Name what you will decline or refer out — and to whom

STEP 2 — Set up the business shell

$100-500 · WEEKS 1-3

- Register, insure, and set up invoicing and a business phone
- Set a minimum charge — tiny free trips kill solo pros

STEP 3 — Price the core list

WEEK 2-3

- Flat prices for your 20 most common jobs
- Half-day and full-day rates for open-ended lists

STEP 4 — First ten customers

WEEKS 3-8

- Neighbors, local groups, realtors and landlords first
- Photograph everything; ask every happy customer for a review

STEP 5 — Build the route

MONTHS 2-4

- Batch jobs by neighborhood to cut windshield time
- Add a simple booking page and reminder texts

STEP 6 — Raise and specialize the mix MONTHS 4-6

- Drop your worst-paying job types; raise minimums
- Add one premium service — smart home installs pair naturally

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: write your real skill list and your decline list. Both matter equally.
- □ Days 1–30: register, insure, price your core 20 jobs, tell everyone you know.
- □ Days 31–60: work your first tickets; photograph, invoice and collect reviews.
- □ Days 61–90: batch jobs by area and set a booking rhythm for repeat clients.
- □ Day 90: a real micro-business — pipeline, prices and reviews, not just a toolbox.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **SMALL JOBS. DONE RIGHT. EVERY TIME.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.